Verb + *-ing* and infinitive with *to*

When you use two verbs together, the second verb appears either in the *-ing* form or in the infinitive.

Use **the *-ing* form** for the second verb:

- after certain verbs, e.g. *enjoy, consider, imagine, recommend*: *Can you **imagine doing** that?*
- after verb + preposition, e.g. *think about, keep on*:

*He **kept on calling** me, although I'd told him not to.*

- after set phrases such as *there's no point, I can't help, it is/isn't worth*:

*Forget it. **It isn't worth worrying** about.*

- as the subject of a sentence:

***Relaxing** after a hard day is important!*

You form the negative with *not* before the *-ing* form:

*Can you **imagine not living** in a city?*

Use **the infinitive with *to*** for the second verb:

- after certain verbs, e.g. *agree, choose, arrange, promise, seem, tend*: *You **seem to be** tired this evening.*
- after *It* + adjective:

***It's delightful to be** here with you again.*

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- to express purpose:

*I'**m calling to tell** you that I won't be coming this evening.*

Form the negative with *not* before *to*:

*We'**ve decided not to sell** the house after all.*

Use both forms after some verbs, e.g. *love, begin, continue,* with little or no change in meaning:

*The company **continued sending/to send** me emails.*

Some verbs can be followed by both forms but the meaning changes, e.g. *remember, forget, stop, go on, try, regret, mean:*

*I **forgot to lock** the door when I went out yesterday.*
(= I should have done this and didn't.)

*I'**ve forgotten saying** anything offensive to him.*
(= I have no memory of this.)

*We **stopped to have** a break and stretch our legs.*
(= finished in order to do something else)

*We **stopped driving** as we were both too tired.*
(= ended an activity)

*I **regret to inform** you that your application has been unsuccessful.* (= formal way of saying sorry)

*I **regret not going** to university.* (= a wish about the past)

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4B Obligation and prohibition

- **Obligation** means it is necessary to do something, either because of external rules or personal need/ authority. You usually use *have to/have got to* or *be required to* for external rules, and *must* or *need to* for personal authority.

*You **have to wear** the uniform at all times when dealing with the public.*

*We **'ve got to be** at the station at 6.00.* (more informal than *have to*; British English only)

*Visitors **are required to report** to reception on arrival.* (more formal than *have to*)

*Come on. We **must go** now or the traffic will be bad.*

*I really **need to do** some exercise; I'm out of condition.*

Must can also be used for strong advice or recommendation, often with *really*:

*You **really must talk** to the directors about a pay rise.*

There is no past or future form of *must*, so you use one of the other verbs, often *have to*:

*When I first started here, we **had to sign in** every morning when we arrived.*

- When there is **no obligation**, use *don't have to, don't need to, needn't* or *not be required to*:

*Staff **don't have to wear** a uniform here, and they **aren't required to be** on duty more than three hours in succession.*

*You **don't need to/needn't** call in advance, just come along when you can.*

Use all these forms in the past:

*We **weren't required to show** our passes at the gate.*

*You **didn't need to bring** your own stationery; we provide everything.*

Note the difference between *didn't need to* and *needn't have*. In the example above, you don't know whether the person brought their own stationery or not. In the following example, you know that they did bring their own stationery:

*You **needn't have brought** your own stationery.*

- **Prohibition** means that it is necessary not to do something. You use *mustn't, can't* and *not be allowed to*:

*We **mustn't/can't/aren't allowed to take** lunch breaks of more than one hour.*

In the past you use only *couldn't* or *wasn't/weren't allowed to*: *In the hospitals trainee nurses **couldn't/ weren't allowed to mix** with the doctors.*

Grammar

Obligation and prohibition

When there is **obligation**, use *have to, have got to, must, need to* and *be required to* to talk about necessary actions.

*You first **have to** pass an exam.*

*You **must** have a degree in English.*

You often use *have to* when talking about rules and *must* when the speaker has authority.

Have got to is common in spoken British English.

In the past, use *had to, was/were required to* and *needed to* (but never ~~*mustn't have*~~).

*You just **had to** get on with it.*

When there is **no obligation** or a choice, use *don't have to, don't need to* or *not be required to.*

*You **don't have to** have any qualifications.*

Depending on context, the meaning can also be 'you're silly if you do it'.

*You **don't have to** pay. It's free!*

In the past, use *didn't have to, didn't need to,* or *weren't required to.*

*You **didn't have to** do that when I was young.*

When there is **prohibition**, use *mustn't, can't, not be allowed to* to talk about actions which are against the rules or strongly against the speaker's advice.

*You **mustn't** fail that exam – it's important.*

*You're **not allowed to** take the exam yet.*

In the past, use *wasn't/weren't allowed to* (but never ~~*mustn't have*~~).

*You **weren't allowed to** work part-time.*

b Look at your answers to Exercise 2a again. Decide if each verb:

1 can take *it* as an object, e.g. *he admitted* ***it***.
2 can take a pronoun as an object, e.g. *she accused* ***me***.
3 doesn't need an object, e.g. *he agreed*.

1 can take it as an object:
admit, deny
2 can take a pronoun as an object:
accuse, threaten, blame, convince, remind, advise
3 doesn't need an object:
agree, refuse, insist, apologise

6.9 Listen to six short conversations. Read the summaries and choose the correct alternatives.

1 Someone ate the apple cake. She *accused*/*convinced* Stephen. Stephen *agreed*/*apologised*.
2 She was leaving. He *reminded*/*advised* her to call. She *agreed*/*refused*.
3 They were late. She *threatened*/*blamed* him. He *admitted*/*denied* it.
4 She asked him to marry her. He *refused*/*insisted* but she *threatened*/*convinced* him.
5 She was changing the wheel. He *advised*/*convinced* her how to do it. She *threatened*/*reminded* him.
6 She didn't want to come out. He *refused*/*insisted*. Somebody hit her brother. She *admitted*/*denied* it.

Look at these examples to see how
must, *might*, *may*, *could*, *can't* and *couldn't* are used in the past.

Scenario

An earthquake? That must have been terrifying!

Deducted information

We don't know for sure that Alex broke the coffee table. It might have been the dog.

How did she fail that exam? She can't have studied very much.

What type of information did the verbs show?

Deducted information


MUST
90-100% sure it's TRUE
+ HAVE + past participle (past meaning)
She must have been in the garden when I called.
Use CAN'T (not MUSTN'T)
He's just left. He can't be too far. (NOT mustn't be)
CAN'T
90-100% sure NOT true
+ HAVE + past participle (past meaning)
You can't have seen her. She was at home.
COULDN'T HAVE + past participle (also possible)
You couldn't have seen her.
MAY MIGHT
30-50% sure it's (or not) true
+ HAVE + past participle (past meaning)
He may have taken a different train. He'll call.
He might not have heard you.
COULD also possible
He could be hurt.
SHOULD
expected to be true
+ HAVE + past participle (past meaning)
You should have packed your things. You're going to be late.
You shouldn't have done/ought not to have done that. It was rude.

What's the Difference?

Adjectives with -ed vs. -ing

-ed

describes a person's own feelings

- bored
- confused
- interested
- excited
- surprised

This lesson is difficult. I am confused!
Kate had nothing to do; she was very bored.

-ing

describes a situation, a thing, or a person that CAUSES the feelings

- boring
- confusing
- interesting
- exciting
- surprising

This lecture is very confusing. I don't understand.
The movie was so boring that Jim nearly fell asleep.

AE

2C -*ed* and -*ing* adjectives

Use adjectives ending in *-ed* to describe how you are feeling:

*We were very **concerned** by what he said!*

You can also use adjectives ending in *-ed* to describe things:

*Do you prefer **baked** or **roasted** potatoes?*

You can use other verbs, as well as *be*, with these adjectives to describe how you are feeling:

*I'm/I **get**/I **feel annoyed** when people are thoughtless.*

*It **makes me (feel) annoyed** when people are thoughtless.*

Use adjectives ending in *-ing* to describe the person, thing or situation that makes you feel a certain way:

*His behaviour was absolutely **disgusting**!*

You can also use adjectives ending in *-ing* to ask for or give an opinion on something:

*I think people who moan all the time are really **irritating**, don't you?*